

locally, making it an ideal tool for cloud-based workflows.

Extensibility without bloat: Unlike VS Code's extension-heavy approach, Lapce is designed with a minimalistic philosophy. While plugins are still being developed, the core editor remains lightweight and fast by default.

Getting started with Lapce

Installing Lapce is a straightforward process. It is available for Linux, macOS, and Windows. To install it, you can download prebuilt binaries from the official website or use package managers:

For macOS using Homebrew, the code is:

```
brew install lapce
```

For Linux (Arch-based distributions), use:

```
pacman -S lapce
```

For Windows, you can download an installer from the official GitHub releases page.

Once installed, you can launch Lapce from the terminal or applications menu.

Writing code in Lapce

Lapce supports a wide range of programming languages with out-of-the-box LSP integration. Here's an example of how Lapce enhances development with Rust.

Open Lapce and create a new Rust project:

```
cargo new osfy-test
cd osfy-test
lapce .
```

Open the project in Lapce and start coding as shown in Figure 1.

The built-in LSP provides real-time syntax checking, autocomplete, and inline documentation. To install it, go to the *Extensions* tab and find the appropriate extension for the language you're working on. In this example, I'm going to install the Rust extension.

Once that is installed, you will have all the LSP features like autocomplete, documentation highlighting, etc.

Version control with Lapce's Git integration

Lapce provides a seamless Git integration experience, allowing developers to manage their source control directly from the editor. With its built-in Git panel, users can stage and commit files effortlessly without needing to switch to an external terminal or a separate Git client. The ability to create, switch, and delete branches within the editor makes branch management more intuitive and accessible.

Viewing differences between file versions is made simple with Lapce's *diff* viewer, which highlights changes in a clear and concise manner. This feature enables developers to track modifications and review code before committing, ensuring better version control practices. Additionally, pushing and pulling changes to and from remote repositories is a smooth process, eliminating the need for external Git tools. These built-in features make Lapce a compelling option for developers who want a lightweight yet powerful editor with integrated Git support.

How fast is Lapce?

Lapce's performance has been one of its strongest selling points. Compared to VS Code, it has been shown to consume significantly less memory while offering comparable or better response times. In tests involving large files and complex projects, Lapce consistently outperforms Electron-based editors.

Should you switch to Lapce?

Lapce presents an intriguing alternative to mainstream code editors, especially for developers who value speed, efficiency, and minimal resource consumption.

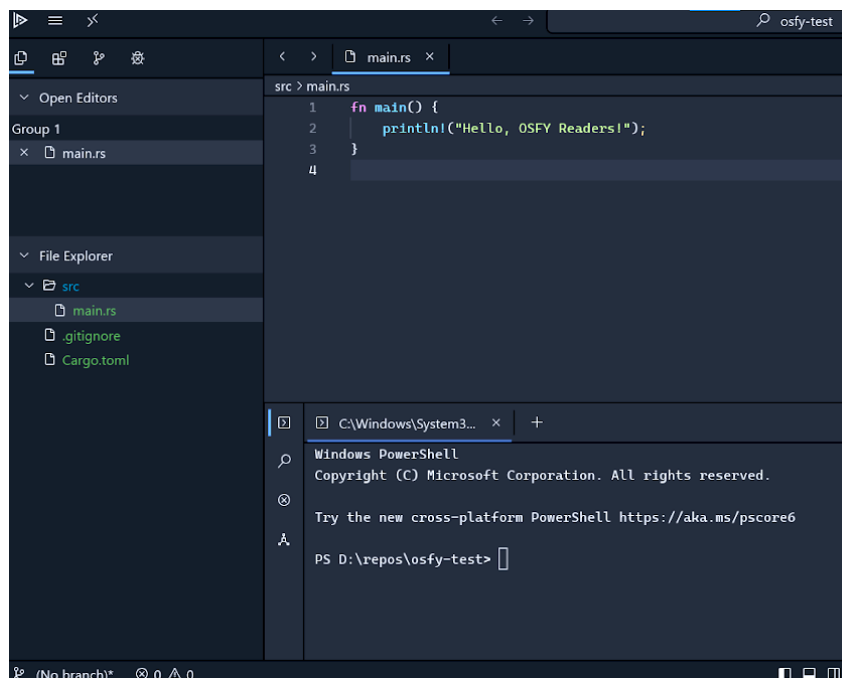


Figure 1: Lapce